

# CodeRabbit CLI - Install Guide

CodeRabbit's CLI runs AI code review on your local repo before you commit. Catches hallucinated function calls, off-by-one bugs, missing tests, hardcoded secrets, race conditions. The kind of stuff Claude or Cursor will generate and you'd ship without noticing. Free to start. This guide is the cleaned-up version of what I actually went through to get it running on Windows.

## Windows (via WSL)

The official install path on Windows is through WSL (Windows Subsystem for Linux). Ten minutes if WSL is already set up, longer if you have to enable it. macOS and Linux are easier — skip to the bottom section for those.

### 1. Enable WSL if it's not already running

Open PowerShell as Administrator and run:

```
wsl --status
```

If it prints kernel info, skip to step 2.

If you see a service error ("service cannot be started, either because it is disabled..."), the WslService is disabled. Enable it:

```
Set-Service -Name WslService -StartupType Manual  
Start-Service -Name WslService
```

If wsl isn't recognized at all, install it:

```
wsl --install -d Ubuntu --web-download
```

Reboot when it finishes. On first launch, Ubuntu prompts you for a username and password — pick anything memorable.

### 2. Install the missing prereq

The CodeRabbit install script needs unzip, which isn't in fresh Ubuntu by default. Install it once:

```
wsl -d Ubuntu --user root -- apt-get update -qq  
wsl -d Ubuntu --user root -- apt-get install -y unzip
```

### 3. Install CodeRabbit CLI

Open a WSL terminal (type wsl in PowerShell, or open Ubuntu from Start menu), then run:

```
curl -fsSL https://cli.coderabbit.ai/install.sh | sh
```

The script installs to ~/.local/bin/coderabbit and adds it to your PATH in ~/.bashrc. Reload your shell so it picks up the new PATH:

```
source ~/.bashrc
```

Verify the install:

```
coderabbit --version
```

You should see something like 0.4.5.

## 4. Authenticate

Sign in via browser OAuth (use a GitHub or GitLab account):

```
coderabbit auth login
```

The CLI opens your default browser, you sign in, the terminal confirms Authentication successful. Verify:

```
coderabbit auth status
```

Should show Logged in plus your account details.

## 5. Run your first review

Navigate into a git repo with some uncommitted changes:

```
cd /mnt/c/path/to/your/repo
coderabbit review
```

Default mode is `--plain` (text findings stream to terminal). Other modes:

- `coderabbit review --interactive` — full-screen TUI, arrow keys navigate findings, Enter to expand
- `coderabbit review --agent` — JSON output for piping into other tools

## macOS / Linux

Single command sequence:

```
curl -fsSL https://cli.coderabbit.ai/install.sh | sh
source ~/.bashrc # or ~/.zshrc if you use zsh
coderabbit auth login
coderabbit review
```

No WSL, no unzip prereq. Done.

## Common gotchas

### Review hangs on “Setting up”

First run of `coderabbit review` auto-adds an origin remote pointing to `github.com/<your-username>/<folder-name>.git` and writes `coderabbit.defaultbranch=main` to `.git/config`. If that GitHub repo doesn't exist, `git-remote-https` will hang for minutes trying to fetch it.

Fix:

```
git remote remove origin
git config --unset coderabbit.defaultbranch
```

Then retry the review.

### “Limited / free CLI behavior” banner

This appears when your local repo isn't tied to a CodeRabbit org install on GitHub. The review still works but is rate-limited. To remove it:

1. Push your repo to GitHub: `gh repo create your-repo-name --private --source=. --remote=origin --push`

2. Go to <https://app.coderabbit.ai/settings/repositories>
3. Click “Add Repository” and install the CodeRabbit GitHub App on the repo you just pushed
4. Run `coderabbit review` again — the banner is gone and reviews run faster

### “coderabbit: command not found” after install

The install adds the PATH update to `~/.bashrc`. If your terminal session was already open before the install ran, it hasn't re-read the file. Two fixes:

- One-time: `source ~/.bashrc`
- Or just close the terminal and open a new one — any new shell picks up the change automatically

## Useful flags

- `--type uncommitted` — review only uncommitted (staged + unstaged) changes
- `--type committed` — review only changes already committed on your current branch
- `--base <branch>` — compare against a specific base branch instead of HEAD
- `--dir <path>` — review a different directory (must contain a git repo)
- `--no-color` — disable terminal color codes (useful for CI logs)

## Where to go from here

The CLI is the local-dev surface. CodeRabbit also runs as a GitHub App that reviews PRs automatically — install it on your repos at [app.coderabbit.ai/settings/repositories](https://app.coderabbit.ai/settings/repositories) to get the same review on every pull request you open.

Try CodeRabbit at: [coderabbit.link/mirkovicdev](https://app.coderabbit.ai/settings/repositories)